

Onboarding Guide — Backend Engineer — TechNova Solutions

Welcome to TechNova!

This guide will help you through your first week as a backend engineer.

Day 1: Environment Setup

1. Clone the main repository: github.com/technova/platform
2. Install Node.js 20+ and Docker Desktop
3. Copy `.env.example` to `.env` and fill in credentials (ask your buddy)
4. Run: `npm install && npm run start:dev`
5. Verify the API is running at `http://localhost:3000`

Day 2: Architecture Deep Dive

- Review the system architecture diagram in `/docs/architecture.md`
- Understand the module structure: `infrastructure/` and `modules/`
- Read the RAG pipeline documentation
- Set up Supabase local instance for development

Day 3: First Task

- Pick a "good first issue" from the GitHub backlog
- Create a feature branch: `feature/your-name/issue-description`
- Write code + tests
- Submit PR with description linking the issue

Day 4: Codebase Walkthrough

- Your buddy will walk you through key modules
- Focus on: authentication, ingestion pipeline, chat service
- Understand how the RAG pipeline works end-to-end

Day 5: Shadowing & Review

- Shadow a senior engineer during code review
- Attend sprint planning meeting
- Review 2-3 PRs from teammates
- Set goals for week 2 with your manager

Key Contacts

- Engineering Lead: Alice Chen (@alice)
- DevOps: Bob Martinez (@bob)
- Security: Charlie Kim (@charlie)
- Product: Emma Wilson (@emma)
- Your Onboarding Buddy: Assigned by manager on Day 1

Useful Links

- Wiki: wiki.technova.io

- GitHub: github.com/technova
- Slack: technova.slack.com
- Monitoring: grafana.technova.io